

Satan's Arsenal Against You

Go ahead and open to Ephesians 6, and then go to 1 Corinthians 12. Let us take the operations of the Body of Christ out of there first, then go back to Ephesians and continue where we left off yesterday, taking it on into the true and the counterfeit.

Put a marker in Ephesians 6, then go to 1 Corinthians 12. Hallelujah.

First Corinthians 12:1 says:

Now concerning spiritual gifts, brethren, I would not have you ignorant.

God knows, if there is any area the Church is ignorant in, it is the operation of spiritual gifts. But Paul began this chapter by saying, "I would not have you ignorant."

By the time he was done, he outlined nine gifts that operate in eight operations of God. He lists those eight operations beginning in verse 27. The nine gifts not only empower the eight operations; they qualify them.

As Pentecostal people, we know more about the nine gifts than probably anything else. But those nine gifts empower and qualify the eight operations of God. These eight operations will consist of two, three, four, six, and sometimes all of the nine gifts, such as in the mighty office of the apostle.

Remember this: if your operation or calling is not empowered by the gifts that make it that calling, then you are not that calling. If you have to run around telling people you are a prophet, you are not. Somebody has to get close enough to you to look at the fruit. If they cannot see any fruit on your tree, there is no use trying to tell them it is there.

"Look a little closer."

"Well, there will be fruit next season."

Then stop your prophesying now. You will have to find another parking lot, because you will not get away with it in here. Some of you do not know what that means. There are people who wait for you to get out of church to prophesy because it is not allowed in church.

Prophecy will qualify itself. Amen. It is a good thing we are not under Old Testament standards, because if it did not come to pass, they hit you in the head with a rock.

Here are these eight operations, qualified and empowered by the nine gifts:

Now ye are the body of Christ, and members in particular.
And God hath set some in the church,
first apostles, secondarily prophets, thirdly teachers,
after that miracles, then gifts of healings, helps, governments, diversities of tongues.

You are members of this Body in particular, like arms, legs, and eyes. You were assigned from the foundation of the world a specific operation and anointing for the Body of Christ. Of course, the will of God is first that you be saved, filled, and trained. But if God gets His way, you will end up in one or more of these eight operations.

Hallelujah, Jesus.

These five operations also encompass pastor and evangelist, but Paul switched to two of the qualifying gifts: workings of miracles and gifts of healings. Healings are prevalent in the pastoral office, and miracles more in the evangelistic office. The entry into the fivefold ministry, apostle, prophet, teacher, pastor, and evangelist, is miracles and healings. Is that not interesting?

Someone says, "I am just a teacher. I am not called to operate in miracles. Just a teacher."

Have you ever wondered why an airplane has two yokes? You are out cross-country with your instructor. He is giving you your test before you solo, and suddenly the plane drops. You say, "I cannot pull it out. Mr. Instructor, take the yoke."

He says, "My God, I cannot fly this thing. I just teach on it."

If you are going to stand up and teach on miracles, it would be nice to have a show later.

Then Paul lists helps and governments, the sixth and seventh operations, and finally the eighth operation: diversities of tongues. It is interesting that he begins with the mighty apostle and goes through seven operations to reach divers tongues. But in 1 Corinthians 13, he switches the order and starts with tongues. He builds through four levels of anointings and finally delivers you back up to the faith of the mighty apostle, agape giving, and finally agape itself.

He goes from apostle to divers tongues, then switches the order and goes from divers tongues all the way to an operation of agape.

But we are not really teaching on callings, offices, or exactly how you reach them. This morning we are teaching on the one who has set himself against you to make sure you never attain to any of it.

You might as well know before we get into this, because some of you may get a little scared. But whether you get scared or not does not change the fact that he is still out there. He is alive, and he has a war machine that functions in government. He can watch you and watch your operation.

Before I get into this, I have some good news for you.

Did you know Satan has been stripped of his authority in two levels to this point? He is going to be stripped one more time, chained up, and then after a thousand years sent to the lake of fire. That will be his last stripping, and he is not going to get out of there to bother anybody ever again. In all the kingdom of God there will be nothing that offends. He will gather it all out.

God created hell for Satan's rebellion and for everyone who wanted to follow him. If you follow him, that is where you will end up with your god. But hell was created for him. God is going to clear everything out of heaven, out of all the operation of the kingdom and the universe, that offends. There will not be anything left that hurts you. He loves you.

Satan lost authority in two levels. The first level was when Jesus said, "I beheld Satan as lightning fall from heaven." He was already cast out of heaven when he entered the garden for the seduction of Adam and Eve. He was already out of heaven. But after the fall, God stepped in and reduced his authority one more time.

If you think a nice-looking snake was standing there talking to Eve, driving up in a Corvette with legs, slicked-back hair, a cigarette holder, and a waxed mustache, that is the most amazing thing to me about the way we think.

It says Lucifer, the serpent, was more subtle than the other beasts of the field. Deceptively wise. Full of wisdom. And I am thinking, what did the cows do, hang around the gate and have an intellectual discourse?

"Hi, Bessie. Did you read The Wall Street Journal today?"

"Oh, here comes the devious one who is going to try to talk us out of our milk."

Come on.

After the fall, when God cursed the serpent, He said, "Upon thy belly shalt thou go, and dust shalt thou eat all the days of thy life." We think He took legs off a snake because it was cursed to eat the dust of the earth. But what He was really talking about was that Satan was limited to an operation of the flesh and the soul.

In other words, he cannot just come up and kill you. He cannot even walk up and kill a sinner. He has to get a sinner to drink himself to death. He cannot just push people off cliffs by the millions. He cannot run up the freeway and exterminate city after city. He has to get someone like Hitler to do it for him.

Why? Because he was cursed to eat the dust of the earth. He was cursed to an operation of the flesh. He cannot make you or anyone else do what you will not do.

As horrible as he gets, he has to break you down. He has to get you to accept disease. He has to cause you to break down mentally and torment you until you get off the Word. If he cannot do that, he cannot defeat you.

Hallelujah. It is nice to know that when we are going to face somebody like the one we are teaching about today.

Go to Ephesians 6. Let us take this in again where we left off.

Ephesians 6:10 says:

Finally, my brethren, be strong in the Lord, and in the power of his might.

This is Paul's conclusion to Ephesians, his final instruction: be strong in the Lord and in the power of His might. Then he tells you how:

Put on the whole armour of God,
that ye may be able to stand against the wiles of the devil.

He would not tell you to do something without telling you how. Put on the whole armor of God, and it gives you the power of His might.

For we wrestle not against flesh and blood,
but against principalities,
against powers,
against the rulers of the darkness of this world,
against spiritual wickedness in high places.

This is not a natural army we are pitted against. He wanted you to know it is organized. That is why he listed principalities, powers, and rulers. He wanted you to know it is as organized as the Roman Empire ever dreamed of being. Although there is not an army marching over a hill, we are still engaged in the same kind of war.

Wherefore take unto you the whole armour of God,
that ye may be able to withstand in the evil day,
and having done all, to stand.
Stand therefore,
having your loins girt about with truth,
and having on the breastplate of righteousness;
And your feet shod with the preparation of the gospel of peace;
Above all, taking the shield of faith,
wherewith ye shall be able to quench all the fiery darts of the wicked.
And take the helmet of salvation,
and the sword of the Spirit, which is the word of God:
Praying always with all prayer and supplication in the Spirit,
and watching thereunto with all perseverance and supplication for all saints.

He used the battle array of a Roman foot soldier to illustrate God's armor. Yesterday we got into that a little bit, especially this piece of the armor: praying.

When God first told me to stop here at the prayer center, we had not named it that yet. God was finally able to take me across the next step by telling me, "You have taken other people's sheep as far as you can take them. Son, I want you to receive an outpouring."

He would have scared me if He had used the word revival, but He said, "I want you to receive an outpouring of My glory." Basically, He said, "I want to have a revival."

I tried to move to three different cities: Florida, Arizona, and Atlanta. Every time I felt like I was getting ready to gear myself up to move, the closer I got to planning it, the more I felt like I was dying inside and could not go. Finally I obeyed Him.

With a group of people, we began to pray. I kept bombarding heaven:

"God, please show me. What stands between us and revival? What stands between us and the outpouring of Your glory, Your power, Your glory cloud in our presence?"

When you take fifty or a hundred little children whose bodies are twisted and whose brains have never been able to break through to the outside world because their bodies hold them prisoner, I know they have a covenant like we have a covenant. I know that. I cannot start getting into this without seeing.

I prayed myself into a place where I would slip into the Spirit and see this periodically.

My little Tawny was different as a girl than the four sons who went before her. I nicknamed her Jabberjaws immediately after she learned to talk. She would ask me five questions before I could even answer the first. Her little body moved at the speed of thought. She would be on my knee asking questions, and I would start to answer, but she would already be across the room picking up a toy.

Little spirits are so active. They switch and do something at the speed of thought. Can you imagine a little free spirit like that locked up in a body that will not move? Do you think it is easy on them?

We have a covenant that says they are free. But nobody wants to pay the price. I am not talking about you paying for them. I mean nobody wants to pay the price of sanctification and separation to be able to handle an outpouring of God's glory like that.

We usually take our covenant only so far, to a nice comfort zone. We believe for a van to haul the child around, a van that lifts him up and out. We sit in a restaurant once in a while talking about the goodness of God, reach over with a handkerchief and clean their face, and then go back to saying, "Is He not good? Did you see the new car He gave me?"

Either we have this covenant or we do not.

As a pastor, who gave me the right to stop anywhere? If you see me out here with a broom in my hand, beat me to death with it. Send me into the back office with a Bible in my hand and slap me until I stay there. There is too much at stake.

"Well, you know, God did not call me to that kind of miracles. I am a teacher."

Do not tell me. I am not the one who needs to be convinced. Get a translator, get through to that child, and go tell the child. I am not the one who needs to be convinced.

You are up against a master. He studied under God. He is Lucifer. He knew how much God loves human beings. He knew the lengths God would go for their salvation. As a counterfeiter, he studied what God did to redeem them and counterfeited it for their destruction.

You are up against a master. He has at least three worlds to his credit before this is over. We misjudge him. In two thousand years, he reduced the early world to one family. It said all flesh went his way. In our world, he has put humanity on a broad path that leads to destruction, while our path is narrow. Through the dark ages, generation after generation finished their generation by jumping off into hell.

At the end of it will be a thousand years with a supernatural government, the millennial reign, with Christ at the head and glorified human beings administering government. The lion will not eat the lamb anymore because of the absence of the curse on the earth. The whole earth will be restored in the regeneration to the original state of the Garden of Eden.

After a thousand years of that, Satan will be loosed for a short season and rally the nations again. You are up against a smart fellow. He has convinced you long before you approach those miracles that they do not really exist for you. You have been conned.

Why would God turn Satan loose for that short season at the end of the millennium? Jesus told the twelve that in the regeneration they would sit on twelve thrones and judge the twelve tribes of Israel. The regeneration period is the millennial reign, when the earth will be restored to the original state of the Garden of Eden under Adam's reign.

After that, it will burn with fervent heat. The elements will pass away, and the earth and the works in it will be burned up. Then the earth will take off her outer garment and put a new one on. In the same way God glorified your body, you will have something glorified like you are to spend the rest of eternity on, an incredible planet that operates like heaven.

But in the millennium, the earth is restored to the original state of the Garden of Eden. Why? Because the full day has to be lived out. God said to Adam, "In the day that thou eatest thereof thou shalt surely die." One day is as a thousand years, and a thousand years as one day. Nobody lived that day out. Adam lived nine hundred thirty years. Methuselah lived nine hundred sixty-nine years. Nobody has lived that day out.

In the regeneration, man will finally live that day out. The second Adam, Christ Jesus, will reign in the garden with His wife, the Body of Christ. Satan will come into the garden again, and the whole thing cycles around. But this time, the last Adam will do what the first Adam was supposed to do: throw him out.

How do you know that? You pray in tongues a lot. You have made a decision to walk into the classroom of the Holy Ghost. He is the Teacher. He is the minister to your understanding of spiritual things. He teaches you what man cannot teach you, such as where the glory and power come from.

We need to put on the whole armor of God that we may stand against the wiles of the devil. Wiles means the methodical, militaristic plots, ploys, and schemes of Diablo. Jesus named the low-level spirits that want to penetrate your life devils. Diablo means penetration.

The devil uses plots, ploys, schemes, and plans against you to penetrate you. He is limited to eating the dust of the earth, limited to an operation of the flesh and soul. If you are spiritually dead, he may gain access to your spirit and possess you like a maniac, but he is limited. He has to talk you into accepting your own defeat.

He does a pretty good job, because the pulpit is occupied by so many people who have taken the power away from you. You do not know.

Did God trust you to an angel? No, sir. The third Person of the Godhead, tri-equal with the other two members of the Godhead, elected to dwell in you.

Greater is he that is in you, than he that is in the world.

God did not trust you to an angel to stand face to face with that killing machine. God Himself dwells in you in all His glory and power to see to it that if you want it, you can walk all the way into the best He has.

The best description of the devil's plan and nature is a single drop of water dropping on a rock day after day, millennium after millennium, generation after generation, until that single drop wears the rock out.

God is the opposite. His grace is not based on what you have done, but on what He has done. When you learn by grace how to release what He has done, it is not you performing, but Him. You can have everything He has for you in a short time.

The devil can set you up for a fall for forty years, and God can reverse it in thirty minutes.

The devil knew God loved human beings so much that he watched how God went after their salvation and redemption. Then he counterfeited everything God did to go after their destruction.

I was praying, "God, what stands between us and the outpouring of Your glory?"

We would raise one group of people up in prayer, and no sooner would we get them raised up than they would start fighting. They would fight with each other until it emptied out. We would try to raise another group, and they would fight with each other until that emptied out.

I said, "God, show me."

I was in my office in this building with my feet up on the desk, a highly conducive position for meditation. I had been praying and waiting on Him before coming out to feed the people. Suddenly, as I was meditating in 1 Corinthians 12 on the eight operations, the page came before me in the Spirit so profoundly that I could read it.

He lifted up from verse 27 and highlighted:

God hath set some in the church, first apostles, secondarily prophets, thirdly teachers...

Then Ephesians 6 came into play right next to it, and He highlighted:

We wrestle not against flesh and blood,
but against principalities,
against powers,
against the rulers of the darkness of this world,
against spiritual wickedness in high places.

I watched as a line of correlation went from the true to the counterfeit. The four operations of Satan counterfeited the eight operations of God.

That is why, when one devil gets cast out, he says, "We have to stop this one. He is garnished and well-furnished. He is going to tear the world up. Go get seven other spirits more wicked than yourself. If he gets past me, get the next one. If he gets past him, get the next one. We have to stop this man. He cannot make it to the eight operations because he will tear the world up."

So they try to get people mad at each other. They try to get them to fall out of prayer over lack of money, circumstances, the color of the carpet, or ugly friends. They try to make them busy.

If you died today, tomorrow would still come. I am afraid the world would get along without you.

Satan esteems himself the god of this world. God is the God of this world by creation; Satan has a lease on it. He is the god of the social systems, and anyone who chooses to serve him has the right to do so.

Have you ever wondered in Jesus' temptation where Satan took Him when he showed Him all the kingdoms of the world? Satan has a throne. He took Jesus to a high mountain and showed Him all the kingdoms of the world. I do not believe he took Jesus' body up there; he took Him into that spiritual place.

Satan said, "I am the god of this world. Your forefather Adam gave this to me. I give these kingdoms to whom I choose. I will make You a world ruler before Your counterpart comes along, Mr. Antichrist. I will make You a world ruler. Just bow down."

Your first Adam did it.

If you want to know what happened in the Garden of Eden, understand Jesus' temptation in the wilderness. What makes you think Satan approached the last Adam any differently than he approached the first? The temptation is no mystery of legless snakes. Give me a break.

Satan has a throne over the religions of the world, and he governs them from that throne.

Brother Dhinakaran, the man we ministered with to half a million people, was a banker. He answered the call as a young man and tried to preach. He saw the need of India, faded back into the darkness of it, and said, "God, where are You? Where is the God of the Old Testament? I cannot go preach to these people. What can I do for them?"

He stayed on his knees so long in prayer that he damaged the nerves in his legs. One day Jesus came and got him, took him to heaven, and began to apostle him. Now he ministers to almost a billion people a month through radio. Jesus personally apostled him for this hour, just as He did the apostle Paul. When he ministers, glory falls, devils flop, and miracles take place.

One day as his ministry was blossoming, he noticed what looked like Jesus coming to get him, but he felt uncomfortable. When the figure got close enough, it was Satan, but he looked just like Jesus. Finally Dhinakaran knew who he was.

Satan addressed him respectfully: "Mr. Dhinakaran, I want you to come with me."

He took him, just as he did Jesus, to that place, a high mountain. There was the throne. Satan sat down on it. Principalities paraded around him like counterfeit cherubim. It looked as if he had duplicated the throne of God. He had the audacity to parade principalities around as a counterfeit.

He said, "Mr. Dhinakaran, I can make you a god. I can make you the wealthiest man. A hemisphere will follow you. They will come and make you a king, a god, if you will just follow me."

Dhinakaran would not even answer him, and Satan had to bring him back.

Satan has that throne. Isaiah prophesied about it. Isaiah 14:13 says:

For thou hast said in thine heart,
I will ascend into heaven,
I will exalt my throne above the stars of God:
I will sit also upon the mount of the congregation,
in the sides of the north:
I will ascend above the heights of the clouds;
I will be like the most High.

I like God's response:

Yet thou shalt be brought down to hell,
to the sides of the pit.
They that see thee shall narrowly look upon thee,
and consider thee, saying,
Is this the man that made the earth to tremble,
that did shake kingdoms;
That made the world as a wilderness,
and destroyed the cities thereof;
that opened not the house of his prisoners?

They will have to squint because they cannot believe this is the one who troubled the earth. He promised grandeur, success, and everything, and now he cannot even get his prisoners out of prison.

He esteems himself as the counterfeit. The next on the true side is Jesus as Head of the Church, then the mighty apostle, prophet, and teacher. I saw the apostle, prophet, and teacher grouped together because they received a mandate from God to indoctrinate the entire world to salvation and God's way of thinking.

Then the line of correlation went over to principality. In the same way the apostle, prophet, and teacher received a mandate to indoctrinate the world to God's way of thinking, principalities received a mandate from Satan to indoctrinate the world to his way of thinking.

These principalities are positioned strategically over nations. Their charge before Satan is to indoctrinate the world through religion into Satan's way of thinking. That is why the Islamic world thinks the same, the Western world with its New Age philosophies thinks the same, and the

Eastern world with its wise-men philosophies thinks the same. They were all indoctrinated by the same god.

The powers answer to the principalities, the rulers of darkness answer to the powers, and spiritual wickedness in high places answer below them.

Paul became so dangerous at the birth of the Church that he had to have a messenger that stood next to Satan assigned to him. Wherever he went, he tore hell up. He said:

Lest I should be exalted above measure through the abundance of the revelations,
there was given to me a thorn in the flesh,
the messenger of Satan to buffet me.

Which of you has so qualified in the presence of God that you had to have something assigned to you that is supposed to tie up a nation, instead of a bunch of low-level devils getting you to stick your tongue out at each other until you drop out of prayer?

We do not really understand the progression from 2 Corinthians 10, 11, and 12. That is why we do not understand Paul's thorn.

The classical verses say:

The weapons of our warfare are not carnal,
but mighty through God to the pulling down of strong holds.

Then in chapter 11, Paul tells you what the strongholds are. He says if someone comes preaching another Christ or another spirit, he is afraid the Corinthians will go along with him. He is not surprised, because Satan himself transforms himself as an angel of light, and his ministers as ministers of light.

False apostles came in and were putting the Corinthians into strongholds with false doctrine. That is why Paul says, "If they say they are of Christ, I am more." Then he began to list his qualifications: prisons more frequent, a day and a night in the deep, stripes, false brethren, fastings by his own choice, and the care of the churches on him. The same devil that was exalting those false apostles was trying to destroy Paul because of his revelation. Paul was the only man alive who could take the Corinthians out of it.

The next correlation was workings of miracles and gifts of healings. I watched the line go to powers.

In the same way gifts of miracles and healings are supposed to be prevalent in the fivefold ministry, so that when you come to church the glory and power of God manifest and any sinner does not have to stand untouched, powers are the counterfeit for workings of miracles and gifts of healings.

Powers empower stigmata, bleeding hands, just enough accreditation to error in doctrine to make people think it is God. They empower the witch doctor hovering above the floor and spinning around. They stood in Pharaoh's courts when the sorcerers threw down their rods and caused them to become snakes. They have a certain amount of power to operate with, and they are the counterfeit.

The next correlation was helps and governments. This one really got me. The line went to the rulers of the darkness of this world.

Helps and governments are supposed to be so skilled that when the Church is running two hundred thousand people, with television ministry and a thousand to three thousand prayer meetings in a section over here, no little believer wanders through any door, gets stamped born again, and escapes the governing gifts. Helps and governments are supposed to make sure a steady stream of supply flows to that little believer on that outpost until he is strong enough to take his own position as a conqueror.

Helps and governments are the eyes that miss nothing.

The ruler of darkness is the counterfeit. Unlike the principality that governs through a power and the power through a ruler of darkness, rulers of darkness are lesser empowered spirits. Their job is over certain regions of darkness, places where there is no revival or where one of Satan's religions is prevalent. Their job is to guard with their lives against invasions of light.

If somebody starts preaching the truth, their job is to organize resistance against him. They are the eyes that make sure no little believer on any outpost anywhere begins to preach the truth without getting slapped down so hard that he thinks about getting up and creating a new religion with no power in it.

Do you think his machine does not watch you? I hope he watches. These are directly responsible, and they watch.

A group of people starts praying, and they say, "No, they are not going to have that."

Do you think you will get a free ride through to glory? This is why people say revival is sovereign. They get slapped so hard that after about the tenth time they say, "Who can endure this? It must be sovereign."

Let me tell you something about His sovereignty. Until the millennium, that stopped at the cross. Since the cross, He has given every human being everything he needs to win his neighbor. There has been no time since the cross that God did not attempt to get you everything you needed to win him.

If God suddenly got off the throne because He was over His headache and decided to start saving people now, I would take Him to court for the generations in the dark ages He let go to hell. If He suddenly started saving people in my generation just because He felt like getting up and doing it, then He would be a respecter of persons, deciding who will be saved and who will not, and what you do would make no difference.

Revival is a field that has been sown. People must stay in there until they are changed enough to know they made the right decision.

At the same time He showed me the war machine, Satan's operation was prevalent at the prayer center. I preached one morning, and it was so bad it would make a man want to cry. The strong man was there killing the service. After that service, about twenty-two people cleared the front rows and left. They went somewhere that revival was supposedly coming sovereignly. People got afraid to sit on the front row.

You survived. You saw them exiting out.

I could see my words trying to preach and going flat, like a spatula-flattened pancake. It was horrible. When I got done, I did not want to pray for anybody. I could see the offering: one hundred ones.

I was going back to my office, thinking, "I have never preached that badly in twenty years." A kind little believer said, "Good preaching, Brother Roberson."

Inside, I said, "Shut up, you liar."

I was right over here, heading for my office, in the middle of a step, when I looked over by the exit sign. There stood a tall man, between six and seven feet, dressed like a Tibetan monk, with an army-blanket kind of robe, a rope, and a hood over his head. His face was receded and rather broad.

I looked at him and thought, "What is this?" I had stepped into the Spirit. He began directing, looking intently over the crowd. He did not know I could see him, because discerning of spirits had kicked in.

Later, in my office, I thought I had seen a vision. But a vision is when God replaces everything. Discerning of spirits is when He opens your eyes and lets you see what is present with what already exists. I was seeing the crowd with devils mixed in.

I had always wondered how Satan could fabricate an anointing and incorporate it over a whole service. God is everywhere at once. The Holy Ghost is everywhere. But the devil is only where he is. How could he cast an anointing over a whole service that killed it?

I knew that morning. He was directing, and the devils had charged the atmosphere. There were so many that traveled with him that they blanketed the atmosphere. They were clamoring and screaming. Although you could not hear it with the natural ear, it created a horrible atmosphere.

This is what they were screaming, and I could hear them that morning. They were saying the same things the twenty-two or so people were saying when they left:

"Can you feel it? There is something wrong here. This will never be blessed. This is not of God. Get out of here as soon as you can."

They were clamoring and clamoring. Even the most faithful followers had problems sticking through that time. We lost several people, some very close to me.

I finished going back to my office and did not really come out of it until I sat down. I had not realized what had happened, because it put me in the Spirit enough that I was adjusted to think it was not that unusual. I was in shock until I got into the office and sat down. Then He made me know that it was a ruler of darkness. That thing travels around with that troop, spot-checking to make sure everything is going wrong.

That is what will come into a church sometimes. Have you ever had a service like that?

Hallelujah.

We have one more operation. The eighth operation is diversities of tongues, and we have one operation of Satan left: spiritual wickedness in high places.

I said, "Oh God, I do not know." My mind and heart ran ahead. I could understand rulers of darkness counterfeiting helps and governments because of the organizational skill. But I could not understand how diversities of tongues was counterfeited by spiritual wickedness in high places.

Spiritual wickedness in heavenly places, or high places, denotes the heaven that surrounds the mountaintops, the air you breathe, the mountaintop level. He is talking about a low-level operation of devils that operates on a direct level with human beings, close as the air you breathe.

Satan is not going to possess a prostitute. He would not dirty himself. He has low-level unclean spirits for that. He does not walk down the street in a prostitute.

The closest Satan could counterfeit you and me receiving the baptism of the Holy Spirit and having the Holy Ghost represent our lives and ministries before the throne room of God for the rest of our lives is a low-level operation of devils that can possess people, operating close as the air they breathe. These spirits seduce, tempt, harass, and try to wear you down like a drop of water until you concede and begin to walk the path of least resistance.

You end up sedated in a chair. You and those who teach you have been slapped so hard that you are tired of charging hell with a water gun. You just sit there, be a nice person, go to work, go home, and die and go to heaven.

"Is there any way I can avoid being slapped? Do not make waves."

Then the devil singles you out for practice. He says, "I am a good killing devil. This person has potential because they heard too much Word. What if they returned from the vomit they have been eating to the gospel? What if they returned and tore hell up? I would have to answer to Satan. I had better get those cancer devils to pay them a visit and get them out of here."

Then you will wish you had charged for God full bore while His Word worked for you. It always worked for you.

I can tell you one thing: if you get into strife and rebellion, I do not care what God has called you to, you will have to straighten that up before He can heal you. Do you think He will heal you to dance with the devil? I am not kidding, my soul.

Let us take a final scenario. Suppose that as pastor you decide one day that God meant what He said:

Give yourself continually to the word of God and prayer.

That is your job: feed the flock.

So you decide to let governments govern while you feed. You say, "I am responsible for eternity for these people. What a responsibility. What a calling. I am going to feed."

You lock yourself up in a pure vein of the Holy Ghost and stay there until feeding time. You pray six to eight hours a day with flurries of worship in between.

Consumed with God, He teaches you how to spend the day with Him if you knock on His door. You learn to flow in and out of things nobody can teach you but Him.

Two years go by, and things in the church may even get worse. Bad services, people leaving. Two or three years go by, and suddenly things begin to change a little. Four years go by, but your faith is what delivers you to that closet because the Word of God says it.

All the time, God has been out ahead of you, working glorious realms, getting ready for an outpouring. Finally the Holy Ghost moves every mountain and gets it into place.

One day you are standing behind the pulpit like normal. You may have long ago dropped the soul emphasis in your preaching. Whether it is shouting with an evangelist or teaching melody with a teacher, it is not what your soul does to the words. It is what the Holy Ghost does. Whether you are shouting or whispering, please be anointed. Go home or go home.

Suddenly, in the Spirit, you hear a noise. The ceiling rolls back like a tuna can. A big hand has the key. Liquid sunshine pours out, splashing in every direction with rainbow colors all over the auditorium.

There is a deaf section over here, forty or fifty people being signed to. Over here, people have been bringing in the homeless. Over there are people from the rest home, sitting in wheelchairs connected to bladder bags. We have been preaching miracles, so they are bringing them in.

When that liquid sunshine pours, chaos follows. Deaf people begin to hear. There is a commotion. Bladder bottles and IVs drag along as people walk out of wheelchairs. People who were destroyed by drugs wake up and say, "Where am I?"

"What is the last thing you remember?"

"Haight-Ashbury. I was licking the stamp."

"You are in church, and this is thirty years later."

In the natural, deaf people call their mothers: "I told you God would do it, Mom. Let me call all your deaf friends." Soon airplanes are loading up. Elderly people walk out and say, "I shed my bladder bottle yesterday and thought I would drop in for tea. Do not put me back in that place or I will have you arrested." People delivered from drugs go out collecting their friends, saying, "Something is going on. His glory has been poured out."

Hallelujah. In the natural, we know how that escalates. God opened the portal to heaven, and you did it because you found out somebody can do that.

If you are going to go somewhere you have never been, you can do something you have never done. If what you are doing is not working, get a clue. Before you call me wrong, taste the water.

What happens in the spirit? Thousands of unclean spirits have come out. They are coming out by the hundreds of thousands. They step over in the corner of the church and say, "We have to do something about this. We had better report to the ruler of darkness. We told him he should assign more people to stop the pastor from praying. Is this our fault? No, this is not our fault. Now we have to petition seven more wicked spirits for every one of these people getting free."

The ruler of darkness then has to collect devils from one end of the state to the other and start sending them in to try to break this up. That is where the fight begins.

Do you remember a few years ago when people were going up in hot-air balloons?

"What are you doing up in that hot-air balloon?"

"I am binding the principality of the air."

They went up in airplanes. "What are you doing?"

"I am getting up where the principality of the air is."

Let me tell you something. If you cause revival like that through prayer, even before you are done praying, like Paul, you will not have to go up in a hot-air balloon to look for him. He will come looking for you. He will find you. Forget the balloon.

His low-level spirits will report to a ruler of darkness, and he will come crashing into your room. He will try everything he can. If he fails, he says, "I have to appeal to a power. I have to go higher."

Then they will try to counterfeit something. "We have to bring this move into sensationalism. Get some devils in there to crow and bark. Drive it past the Holy Ghost. If we can do it, we can take a lot of people with us."

Finally, the power appeals to a principality. He tries to stop it, but he cannot stop you, like Paul. At that point, you find the sufficiency of grace. But if you do not know what is happening, he will stop you.

This is why William Branham, with religious spirits and destructions of reasonings, began to think he was Elijah to come. This is why John Alexander Dowie, after God used him mightily in healing, began to think he was Elijah to come. The day he announced it, they tell me, he sat down and never preached again.

These spirits destroy reasonings.

George Jeffreys was another. I asked an intercessory woman who lived here before she went home to be with Jesus, "Who was the mightiest healing evangelist you ever saw? Was it Kathryn Kuhlman? I know she stayed in your home."

She said, "No."

"Was it Jack Coe?"

"No," she said. "It was a man from England who made a pass through America by the name of George Jeffreys."

They brought fields of people in. He would say, "No man has focused this man, Jesus," and people began to get up all over the field. Ambulances and everything. Blind eyes snapped open. God used him especially for arthritis.

After thirty years of ministry, destructions of reasonings came and convinced him that Britain was a lost tribe of Israel. He started preaching British Israelism and also lost his life over it.

Satan knows his business.

Paul said the messenger of Satan was after him because of the abundance of his revelations. He said, in effect, "You only know what I found out. I lost everything. I was stripped of everything. I lost family. In the middle of being stripped, I found out I had nothing else left, nothing to turn to. Three times the Lord told me, 'My grace is sufficient for thee.' When I found out what that grace was, it switched my dependency off the flesh and onto the Spirit. When there was nothing left, that was when I found out how strong He was, because I depended on nothing else."

Nothing else.

And so, will you sleep with the fathers and take your place as a revivalist?